

ATTRACTION: Dungeshwari Temple

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Pragbodhi Caves

LOCATION:

Dungeshwari Hills, along the Falgu River, Pragbodhi, Gaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya

CATEGORY:

Religious Site

OVERVIEW:

The caves in Dungeshwari Hills are said to have protected Lord Buddha for six years before he descended to Bodhgaya to attain enlightenment. These historic caves, located about 12-15 Kms from Gaya along the Falgu river, now house several temples visited by pilgrims following Lord Buddha's journey. Although the caves may lack striking visual appeal, they are reputed to offer a surreal experience due to their transcendental energy. One of the cave temples is dedicated to the Hindu goddess, Dungeshwari, adding to the site's rich religious tapestry.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

Located in the Dungeshwari Hills along the Falgu River, about 12-15 Kms from Gaya, the site consists of caves that housed Lord Buddha for six years prior to his enlightenment. Today, the caves house several temples. While the physical caves may be visually plain, they hold immense spiritual value. One of the cave temples is dedicated specifically to the Hindu Goddess Dungeshwari, making the site significant for both Buddhist and Hindu pilgrims.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

These caves hold immense historical and religious significance as they sheltered Lord Buddha for six years before his enlightenment. The site was also mentioned by the famous Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang in his travelogue. It serves as a major pilgrimage site for those following the trail of Buddha's journey.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

It is believed that these very caves protected Lord Buddha for six years before his descent to Bodhgaya. The site is imbued with transcendental energy, and one of the cave temples serves as a shrine to the Hindu goddess Dungeshwari.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Caves that protected Lord Buddha for six years before his enlightenment.
- Cave temple dedicated to the Hindu Goddess Dungeshwari.
- Mentioned by the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang.
- Located along the scenic Falgu River.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 05:00 AM - 05:00 PM

Entry Fee: Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned

Photography: Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information: Not Mentioned

FACILITIES:

- Parking
- Drinking Water

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Gaya International Airport

Distance From Airport: 19 Kms

Nearest Railway Station: Gaya Junction

Distance From Railway Station: 14 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand: Bhusanda Bus Stand (Pvt.)

Distance From Bus Stand: 08 Kms

Road Connectivity: Not Mentioned

Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Tourist Information Centre, Gaya Junction (14 Kms)

Nearest Police Station: Bodhgaya Police Station (13 Kms), Ph: 0631-2200741

Nearest Medical Facility: Sadar Hospital, Gaya, Mob: 9470003263; Anugrah Narayan Magadh Medical Collage & Hospital, Gaya Ph: 0631-221074

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Mahabodhi Mandir (13 Kms)
- 80 feet Buddha state (13 Kms)
- Thai Temple (13 Kms)
- Vishnupad Mandir (12 Kms)
- Mangla Gauri Mandir (11 Km)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Pilgrimage following the trail of Lord Buddha's journey; a surreal experience of transcendental energy.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

- Vishnu View Hotel (Mob: 9608556289)
- Ajatsatru Hotel (Mob: 9798881223)
- Hotel Mantra Regency (Mob: 9973357885)
- Hotel Royal View (Mob: 9431224222)

HOTELS:

- Vishnu View Hotel
- Ajatsatru Hotel
- Hotel Mantra Regency
- Hotel Royal View

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Mukesh Kumar, Mob: 9818660231
- Harendra Kumar, Mob: 9708472519

- Dayanand Kumar, Mob: 9718579981
- Prakash Renukarjun, Mob: 8809630151
- Ram Lakhan Kumar, Mob: 9934636962

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Gupta Tour & Travels (Mob: 8507192638)
- Vishal Tour & Travels (Mob: 9006169000)
- Maa Vaishnavi Tour & Travels (Mob: 8083329781)
- Surya Services (Mob: 9431094940)

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Located 12-15 Kms from Gaya.
- Mentioned in Hiuen Tsang's travelogue.
- Known for both Buddhist and Hindu religious significance.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Dungeshwari Temple, located in the Dungeshwari Hills along the Falgu River in Pragbodhi, Gaya, is a deeply significant religious site for Buddhists and Hindus. The caves here are believed to have protected Lord Buddha for six years before he attained enlightenment in Bodh Gaya. Mentioned by Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang, the site includes a temple dedicated to Goddess Dungeshwari. It is located 19 km from Gaya International Airport and 14 km from Gaya Junction, open to visitors from 05:00 AM to 05:00 PM (best visited October to March). Nearby attractions include Mahabodhi Mandir and Vishnupad Mandir.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is the significance of the Dungeshwari Hills caves for Buddhists?

A: It is believed that these caves protected Lord Buddha for six years before he travelled to Bodhgaya for enlightenment.

Q: Which Hindu goddess has a temple in the Dungeshwari caves?

A: The Hindu goddess Dungeshwari.

Q: Which famous historical traveler mentioned Dungeshwari Hills?

A: Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang mentioned these hills in his travelogue.

Q: How far is Dungeshwari Temple from Gaya?

A: It is located at a distance of about 12-15 Kms from Gaya.

Q: What are the nearest transit points to Dungeshwari Temple?

A: Gaya International Airport (19 Kms) and Gaya Junction (14 Kms).

KEYWORDS:

Dungeshwari Temple, Pragbodhi Caves, Gaya, Lord Buddha, Falgu River, Hiuen Tsang, Dungeshwari Hills, Buddhist Pilgrimage, Hindu Goddess Dungeshwari